

Managing Anxiety

You have been sent this resource as we understand that you have been struggling with anxiety. Anxiety is a very normal response that happens to everyone at some point in their life, so don't worry you are not alone. This pack has been created to help you understand what anxiety is and ways to manage it.

Suggested Apps

Please find below a list of resources that other children, young people and families have found useful in the past. We hope that you find these helpful.

App	Helpful for...
Smiling Mind 	• Age: suitable for all ages • Provides different guided relaxation and mindfulness exercises • Free
Chill Panda 	• Age: children • Work through quests and tasks based on how you are feeling • Provides breathing and stretching exercises • Free
Head Space 	• Age: older children and adolescents • Provides mindfulness exercises • Has a free trial
Calm 	• Age: older children and adolescents • Provides relaxation exercises including a visual aid for controlled breathing techniques • Has some free components and some paid components
Mindshift 	• Age: older children and adolescents • MindShift™ CBT uses scientifically proven strategies based on Cognitive Behavioural Therapy (CBT) to help you learn to relax and be mindful, develop more effective ways of thinking, and use active steps to take charge of your anxiety. • Free • https://www.anxietycanada.com/resources/mindshift-cbt/
Hospichill 	• Age: children • Includes different activities such as relaxation skills with animations, distraction ideas and other helpful tools for managing anxiety about an upcoming hospital appointment or procedure • Free

Websites

Please find below some useful websites with more information to help you understand and manage anxiety.

NHS Inform Anxiety self help guide for teenagers and adults: www.nhsinform.scot/illnesses-and-conditions/mental-health/mental-health-self-help-guides/anxiety-self-help-guide	
YoungMinds - Information and advice for teenagers on how to cope with anxiety: youngminds.org.uk/find-help/conditions/anxiety/	
A link to free parenting programmes to help parents to manage children and young people's behaviours: www.joininedinburgh.org/parenting-programmes/	
Canadian website that provides helpful free anxiety psychoeducation and resources www.anxietycanada.com	
Fight/flight/freeze anxiety psychoeducation video by Anxiety Canada: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FfSbWc3O_5M (for children)	
Fight/flight/freeze anxiety psychoeducation video by Anxiety Canada: www.youtube.com/watch?v=rp0lpKTWrp4 (for teenagers)	
There are free stress management classes called Stress Control available to those aged 16+ https://services.nhslothian.scot/stresscontrol/Pages/default.aspx https://stresscontrol.org/stress-control	